

GPT-5.5 (Generative Pre-trained Transformer 5.5) is a large language model (LLM) released by OpenAI on April 23, 2026. The model is also known by its codename "Spud".

OpenAI reported GPT-5.5 benchmark scores including 82.7% on Terminal-Bench 2.0, 51.7% on FrontierMath Tier 1–3, and 35.4% on FrontierMath Tier 4, while listing lower scores for Claude Opus 4.7 and Gemini 3.1 Pro on the same benchmarks.

OpenAI said a recurring tendency in its models to mention goblins, gremlins, and other creatures began with GPT-5.1 and became noticeable in GPT-5.5's Codex testing. The company attributed the behavior to rewards used when training the "Nerdy" personality, which favored creature-word outputs and transferred beyond that personality during later training. OpenAI said it retired the Nerdy personality, removed the goblin-affine reward signal, filtered training data containing creature words, and added a developer-prompt instruction for GPT-5.5 in Codex. In April 2026, a GPT-5.5 developer-prompt instruction in the GitHub repository of Codex told it not to mention goblins if the user prompt did not require it.

GPT-5.5-Cyber, along with Codex Security, was being used in June 2026 at the launch of the Patch the Planet project to help open-source projects find and fix vulnerabilities.

Release

GPT-5.5 Thinking and GPT-5.5 Pro were released on April 23, 2026, with neither being available to free-tier users. OpenAI withheld API access at launch, saying that API deployments required "different safeguards"; GPT-5.5 and GPT-5.5 Pro became available in the API on April 24, 2026. GPT-5.5 Instant was released to free-tier users on May 5, 2026, replacing GPT-5.3 Instant as ChatGPT's default model for all users. On May 7, 2026, OpenAI announced GPT-5.5-Cyber, a limited-preview variant for vetted cybersecurity teams under its Trusted Access for Cyber program.

Reception

ZDNET praised GPT-5.5 for its polished answers and "[s]trong performance across writing, coding, and reasoning tasks". Compared to its predecessor GPT-5.4, the website described GPT-5.5 as better, faster, and showing "improvements in agentic coding, conceptual clarity, scientific research ability, and accuracy during knowledge work".

The AI Security Institute reported that GPT-5.5 had a 71.4% ($\pm 8.0\%$, one standard error) average pass rate on its expert-level cyber tasks, compared with 68.6% ($\pm 8.7\%$) for Anthropic's Claude Mythos Preview, and said GPT-5.5 "may be the strongest model we have tested" on that measure.

References

External links

Official website